Skechers Email Review: “Tell us more about you!”

Walker · US market · Executive summary first, evidence after

Executive Summary

*Subject: Tell us more about you!

*Campaign: TRG_US_EN_PLUSWELCOME_3_09082025

*Date Reviewed: 2026-03-15

This is email #3 in the Skechers PLUS welcome series, targeting new loyalty members with a profile-completion incentive. The strategic intent is correct — collect zero-party data, award points, enable downstream personalization. The execution undermines itself in a fundamental way: the email pitches personalization while greeting the recipient as "Hi ," with a visibly empty name field. That contradiction alone tanks credibility. Compound it with broken product recommendation links, a wall of HTTP image assets that may not load in secure email clients, and zero plain-text fallback, and you have a technically deficient send that also fails the very promise it's making. The bones are right. The production quality is not.

Business Impact Score: 4/10

What’s Working

- Clear single objective. Profile completion is the ask, points are the hook. The email doesn't try to do ten things.
- Points-as-incentive structure works. Tying profile completion to points earning is the right mechanic for a loyalty welcome series. It closes the loop on why PLUS membership matters.
- Layered CTAs with reasonable hierarchy. Primary profile CTA, secondary points redemption nudge, and a tertiary SMS opt-in gives the email depth without being chaotic.
- Personalized product recommendations module is present. The intent to surface relevant product recs as a "preview" of what personalization delivers is a smart editorial choice in a profile-completion email.
- SMS acquisition module is appropriately placed. Cross-channel opt-in belongs in a welcome series and is positioned without dominating the email.

What’s Weak

- Broken greeting token — critical. The email opens with "Hi ," — empty name field. On an email explicitly about personalization, this is a self-defeating failure.
- Product recommendation links are broken. All three iGoDigital rec links throw encoding errors (ASCII codec can't encode Unicode ellipsis in the URL). Clicking any product tile likely results in a broken destination.
- HTTP image assets across the board. The Skechers logo, App Store badge, Google Play badge, Curbside Pickup, AfterPay, Find A Store, and all three social icons are served over HTTP. Email clients enforcing HTTPS (including iOS Mail with image proxying, Outlook) may block or break these silently. A significant portion of the visual structure is at risk.
- No plain-text fallback. Zero characters. This is both a deliverability risk (spam filters penalize HTML-only sends) and an accessibility failure.
- Product rec images missing alt text. If images are blocked (see HTTP issue above), there's no fallback text to communicate what was there.
- Duplicate "COMPLETE PROFILE" CTAs. There's both a long-form "COMPLETE YOUR PROFILE FOR A PERSONALIZED EXPERIENCE" CTA and a short "COMPLETE PROFILE" button that appear to be redundant without meaningful differentiation. Slightly dilutes the primary action.
- SMS opt-in image (phone graphic) also missing alt text. If this image fails to load, the module renders as a blank block with an ambiguous CTA.

Recommendations

- Fix the greeting token immediately. Audit the merge field configuration for %%First Name%% or equivalent. Add a fallback value ("Hi there," or "Hi SKECHERS PLUS member,") for any subscriber where first name is null. This is P0 for a lifecycle series.

- Fix the product recommendation URL encoding. The Unicode ellipsis character (…) in iGoDigital rec URLs is breaking link resolution. Either truncate item identifiers in the URL or ensure the link builder encodes non-ASCII characters correctly before send. Verify all three rec slots are resolving to valid PDPs before next send.
- Migrate all image assets to HTTPS. The image.emails.skechers.com CDN is serving over HTTP. Move all assets to HTTPS immediately. This is a rendering liability that will silently fail in a growing percentage of email clients.
- Add plain-text fallback. Minimum viable: include the subject, the main CTA headline, the profile completion URL, and the unsubscribe link. A zero-character plain-text version is a deliverability red flag.
- Add alt text to product rec tiles and the SMS module image. If images block, the email should still communicate intent. Product tile alt text should be descriptive (e.g., "Women's GO WALK running shoe — recommended for you").
- Consolidate or differentiate the profile CTAs. Either merge the two profile-completion CTAs into one clear primary action, or give each a distinct role (e.g., one for desktop above-fold, one as a sticky mobile CTA) rather than repeating nearly identical language.
- Audit the REDEEM module. Two REDEEM CTAs appear in the email — confirm these are pointing to distinct destinations (e.g., different reward tiers) rather than duplicated by template error.

Evidence

*Overall purpose of the email

Welcome series, email #3. Goal: drive PLUS members to complete their profile in exchange for loyalty points. Secondary goals: SMS opt-in acquisition, app download, product discovery. The profile completion objective is well-suited for this position in the welcome sequence.

*Hero / primary value proposition

"Tell us more about you!" with a points incentive for profile completion. The value exchange (your data → our personalization → your points) is stated but not quantified — the email doesn't specify how many points completing a profile earns, which weakens the motivational hook. Quantifying the reward ("Earn 50 points") would sharpen conversion.

*Membership / benefits section

Points redemption is surfaced via a "REDEEM" module, which reinforces that earned points have real value. This is good reinforcement for early-journey members who may not have redeemed yet. However, two REDEEM CTAs appearing in the email without differentiation reads as template redundancy.

*Product discoverability / recommendation modules

Three product tiles powered by iGoDigital (Salesforce recs engine). Conceptually strong — showing what personalization looks like serves as a direct demonstration of why profile completion matters. Execution is broken: all three recommendation URLs throw ASCII encoding errors and will fail to resolve. Images on the tiles are also missing alt text, so if images are blocked, the module renders as blank boxes. This module needs to be fixed or suppressed until it works.

*Utility / secondary modules

SMS opt-in: "LET'S GET TEXTING" / "Text SKECHERS to 83828" — appropriate placement, below primary CTA. The image for this module is missing alt text and served without HTTPS on image assets.

App download: App Store + Google Play badges — present in the lower email. Both badge images are HTTP-served.

Curbside Pickup / AfterPay / Find A Store: Footer utility strip is present and contextually relevant for a loyalty audience. All three icons are HTTP-served.

Social: Instagram, Facebook, YouTube — standard footer social strip, all HTTP-served images.

*Email-to-site continuity

Cannot fully validate due to rate limiting on primary CTAs and broken rec links. The profile completion CTA flow — if functioning — should land on a logged-in account profile page. The rec tiles, when working, should land on product detail pages. Continuity is structurally designed but functionally unverified due to link failures.

*Bugs / friction / clarity issues

[CRITICAL] Empty greeting token: "Hi ," — visible to all recipients where first name wasn't captured or didn't merge.

[CRITICAL] Product recommendation links broken: Unicode encoding error in all three iGoDigital rec URLs.

[HIGH] 14 image assets served over HTTP — at risk of being blocked silently in major email clients.

[HIGH] No plain-text fallback — 0 characters. Deliverability and accessibility risk.

[MEDIUM] 6 images missing alt text (3 product recs, SMS module image, 2 others) — visual fallback entirely absent.

[LOW] SPF/DKIM authentication status unverified via relay — monitor for deliverability signals.

Automated QA

Pass rate: 12% • Issues: 5 • Warnings: 25

Link Analysis

- ■ Rate limited (429): Server returned 429 — link may be valid (link text: "REDEEM") | https://click.emails.skechers.com/?qs=eyJkZWtJZCI6IjEwMzhmY2ZjLTdmNzMtNGVhMC04N2E4LWQ0MGE4ZDk0ZTdhMiIsImRla1ZlcnNpb24iOjEsIml2Ijoid2NGL0ExdFB3TWQ2b0ZzSEVaOWl1QT09IiwiY2lwaGVyVGV4dCI6Im5vM3pJOTBZNnNjdi9sMHNFTmhwUFlGWTdPN1dqamMxVWIrVjNTNFFIdndrdjl2Z0lBbmRFdHZMQU9jZ2JwVDJVVW1vZURSU0p3K2tIV1hEVXVGUStBVmhQbjQxRjdBNGVUSkp2M3FSd2NGL0ExdFB3TWQ2b0ZzSEVaOWl1QT09IiwiYXV0aFRhZyI6IlVQZ0ZZVDUrTlJld09Ia3lTYjk2a1E9PSJ9
- ■ Rate limited (429): Server returned 429 — link may be valid (link text: "REDEEM") | https://click.emails.skechers.com/?qs=eyJkZWtJZCI6ImNiYWFmOGI1LWQwY2ItNGVlNi1hMDE4LTM3NWY3MTk1Njg0MSIsImRla1ZlcnNpb24iOjEsIml2IjoienVhZUE1bVloTkhKZE10aWdZd2tUQT09IiwiY2lwaGVyVGV4dCI6IkRTM3NLbkYrZ0o4L1BTYmRibmJpRVhPbzY2Sm9NTjZXcnhuWnM1TW9lRmxjcGtsOFByTUFwd1MzMDJBelhlV3o4b0pRQzhkTEhjdU5lZzMzVHB4dkxxWHdKNUEvTkdOZlBwaUt2ZnFYenVhZUE1bVloTkhKZE10aWdZd2tUQT09IiwiYXV0aFRhZyI6ImJ5Nmw4Q2VRUHpSalh6NllpcjM2bHc9PSJ9
- ■ Rate limited (429): Server returned 429 — link may be valid (link text: "HELP US GET TO KNOW YOU! (AND EARN POINTS TOO!)") | https://click.emails.skechers.com/?qs=eyJkZWtJZCI6ImM4NDBlNGIzLTMyODItNDc4MC04NTJhLTIwYWRmMmZlNDQyOSIsImRla1ZlcnNpb24iOjEsIml2IjoiWXI0b3ZxV2dwVEd5QlB5NXJObWpOQT09IiwiY2lwaGVyVGV4dCI6IklDMVpoT1lBSnRSUnNVajB2OWdiamlxUTEyQzU5THk0MEQ4U3VTQlhnK2lwMms2VlUza0RSYnRqdlhOb3ZFTWF2MFk3NzhyZ2dVQUVDNnM3bFJUajkwZnJOQkFDRXlWTlRVZUQ2TE9lWXI0b3ZxV2dwVEd5QlB5NXJObWpOQT09IiwiYXV0aFRhZyI6IjQvZEg2elFRQWhNbFRVMUhnK2l6bmc9PSJ9
- ✘ Link error: 'ascii' codec can't encode character '\u2026' in position 59: ordinal not in range(128) | https://100007688.recs.igodigital.com/rr/v2/5bfd72be23e5401729d17e23/i/1/8107766165?item=pr…
- ✘ Link error: 'ascii' codec can't encode character '\u2026' in position 59: ordinal not in range(128) | https://100007688.recs.igodigital.com/rr/v2/5bfd72be23e5401729d17e23/i/2/8107766165?item=pr…
- ✘ Link error: 'ascii' codec can't encode character '\u2026' in position 59: ordinal not in range(128) | https://100007688.recs.igodigital.com/rr/v2/5bfd72be23e5401729d17e23/i/3/8107766165?item=pr…
- ■ Rate limited (429): Server returned 429 — link may be valid (link text: "COMPLETE YOUR PROFILE FOR A PERSONALIZED EXPERIENCE") | https://click.emails.skechers.com/?qs=eyJkZWtJZCI6IjM1YzFiZTFiLTM4NzQtNGQ3ZC1hN2MwLWRjY2I4NjcwNDdkZCIsImRla1ZlcnNpb24iOjEsIml2IjoiN0tzeTJiUFdvMUx2MUp3ZTRaYzJuZz09IiwiY2lwaGVyVGV4dCI6IjVVeXBEM0F5Vk9NTlhrNnhjNkRDazVvaXJRTjV5T3dNWmNNdURsUVNJaUZodFY4aithVXc2allOOTJtL0Jjd3M0UUJSZmR5L011cDl2ZEtJaVE4azJ4aS8zSllkNFpSYmp3UklXTitCN0tzeTJiUFdvMUx2MUp3ZTRaYzJuZz09IiwiYXV0aFRhZyI6IkpOc1l2OXlXSGVHVVc0OEVTRmpmZ1E9PSJ9
- ■ Rate limited (429): Server returned 429 — link may be valid (link text: "COMPLETE PROFILE") | https://click.emails.skechers.com/?qs=eyJkZWtJZCI6IjViNzEwMGJjLTYwMmEtNDE0YS1iMGNmLTY4MzdkNTJlNjZlMiIsImRla1ZlcnNpb24iOjEsIml2IjoiSXhXNHEyUWFkUjJ6OWs5cjdRKy81UT09IiwiY2lwaGVyVGV4dCI6ImdUdHpLVW0xc1NVNzJUZkxjbC90ME0wSzljUThtWU43eUU0Z3pubWRzdi90KzZBekc5KzA3Z244QVRDQ0t0YTltVFRrY2wrYUNYK3l4VXhlR2JGMGRrWVZFblJzRVBNTWtPbSs4YmpiSXhXNHEyUWFkUjJ6OWs5cjdRKy81UT09IiwiYXV0aFRhZyI6ImRIWkdGUkowYkJEekRKRHB2dkc0Mnc9PSJ9
- ■ Tracking link returned 400: Email tracking links commonly reject direct probes or expire (link text: "[image: 49468f73-4651-4af3-bea2-61d1ae5db486.png]") | https://click.emails.skechers.com/?qs=eyJkZWtJZCI6IjA1NTkxZWRjLWY3ODEtNDlkYi04OTcxLTdmYTIwZTk2NGQ4NSIsImRla1ZlcnNpb24iOjEsIml2IjoiaIFWRXFuUGV4NjF0QXhUaG5TZnVIdz09IiwiY2lwaGVyVGV4dCI6IlIvTWdNOSswT0FNMEw2L2JYR3ppRG5pZGpEU3FXd2JaY0dvRkRXaldoQVhPMnZTUGVhSVdZbGN2dTZxUCtLRzJKZElBRmJ4SGQrWXlKY05UNmR2dFZxMWdhTFJNdTJiOE11T1c2L2c0alFWRXFuUGV4NjF0QXhUaG5TZnVIdz09IiwiYXV0aFRhZyI6IjdWYXRZR2kwVEx0bS9ETGpsdXY0T0E9PSJ9
- ■ Tracking link returned 400: Email tracking links commonly reject direct probes or expire (link text: "LET'S GET TEXTING") | https://click.emails.skechers.com/?qs=eyJkZWtJZCI6IjZlMjc5ZDFhLTE5OGMtNGIxZS1hZDljLWZlNjljZWZmMTY4YiIsImRla1ZlcnNpb24iOjEsIml2IjoiU3F6c2FDNm9md3NMSjl5UXM0cjVxUT09IiwiY2lwaGVyVGV4dCI6InhhUURpNDdaTi95SCtvWk1QQ2FqbDFuOWlaUldlYVI0Q3Q5b285Q0hma2FQVC9TU2tvZ3VFaEJ0cG5HT1FqL1d6TUl0TE9FQkJWTkt0TklkTkdBM2

tTWVZRdngyNHd2b0FycVR0TW8rU3F6c2FDNm9md3NMSjl5UXM0cjVxUT09IiwiYXV0aFRhZyI6Ik41RW1GVUw4ZHVNTDZBSzZrN1RLUGc9PSJ9

- ■ Tracking link returned 400: Email tracking links commonly reject direct probes or expire (link text: "Text SKECHERS to 83828 for exclusive offers!") | https://click.emails.skechers.com/?qs=eyJkZWtJZCI6IjhiZjI3Y2YzLTE3ZTktNDhkYS04ZGNlLTRiM2NkYzc0MzQ3ZCIsImRla1ZlcnNpb24iOjEsIml2IjoiKzhBaFJQQWhFVktTOFYwRUVKVVRldz09IiwiY2lwaGVyVGV4dCI6Ilh0cS9pTDQ5YXBTM28rYVNPaFNoZUtjSFJ4S0NRbE9SaGlCeVZZcDZoSGEwUWVlYWhIeXJOT2pHK2dFYW1VNlAvY2k5Tm1GZ2tiRmNqbTJ6N3M3bjNjVk92TkZEY1BSNHh1RUwxTDcxKzhBaFJQQWhFVktTOFYwRUVKVVRldz09IiwiYXV0aFRhZyI6IjU5M0ZUcnpSUTNEMGVNYmhDOVMrOVE9PSJ9

Rendering & Visual

- ■ Image missing alt text: o.gif: src: http://www.ink1000.com/p/up/7076d8b15a776085/o.gif?mi_u=8107766165&mi;_ecmp=TRG_US_EN_PLUSWELCOME_3_09082025
- ■ Image uses http://: o.gif: Non-HTTPS source may be blocked — src: http://www.ink1000.com/p/up/7076d8b15a776085/o.gif?mi_u=8107766165&mi;_ecmp=TRG_US_EN_PLUSWELCOME_3_09082025
- ■ Image uses http://: "Skechers" (dde00662-169f-447d-b0e2-fc65f6c2290c.png): Non-HTTPS source may be blocked — src: http://image.emails.skechers.com/lib/fe3115707564047a731c78/m/1/dde00662-169f-447d-b0e2-fc65f6c2290c.png
- ■ Image missing alt text: 8107766165: src: https://100007688.recs.igodigital.com/rr/v2/5bfd72be23e5401729d17e23/i/1/8107766165?item=pr… alias=
- ■ Image missing alt text: 8107766165: src: https://100007688.recs.igodigital.com/rr/v2/5bfd72be23e5401729d17e23/i/2/8107766165?item=pr… alias=
- ■ Image missing alt text: 8107766165: src: https://100007688.recs.igodigital.com/rr/v2/5bfd72be23e5401729d17e23/i/3/8107766165?item=pr… alias=
- ■ Image missing alt text: 49468f73-4651-4af3-bea2-61d1ae5db486.png: src: http://image.emails.skechers.com/lib/fe3115707564047a731c78/m/11/49468f73-4651-4af3-bea2-61d1ae5db486.png
- ■ Image uses http://: 49468f73-4651-4af3-bea2-61d1ae5db486.png: Non-HTTPS source may be blocked — src: http://image.emails.skechers.com/lib/fe3115707564047a731c78/m/11/49468f73-4651-4af3-bea2-61d1ae5db486.png
- ■ Image uses http://: "Available on the App Store" (0ec56c9f-eec2-471a-898d-0ca1cea7e115.png): Non-HTTPS source may be blocked — src: http://image.emails.skechers.com/lib/fe3115707564047a731c78/m/11/0ec56c9f-eec2-471a-898d-0ca1cea7e115.png
- ■ Image uses http://: "Android App on Google Play" (9bb508d0-4b38-483d-8459-cf54186a0b9f.png): Non-HTTPS source may be blocked — src: http://image.emails.skechers.com/lib/fe3115707564047a731c78/m/11/9bb508d0-4b38-483d-8459-cf54186a0b9f.png
- ■ Image uses http://: "Curbside Pickup" (00100b23-0afa-4715-a8cd-23bb46f9d2b2.png): Non-HTTPS source may be blocked — src: http://image.emails.skechers.com/lib/fe3115707564047a731c78/m/11/00100b23-0afa-4715-a8cd-23bb46f9d2b2.png
- ■ Image uses http://: "AfterPay" (07cb60b5-512b-494d-892d-67dc067289b7.png): Non-HTTPS source may be blocked — src: http://image.emails.skechers.com/lib/fe3115707564047a731c78/m/11/07cb60b5-512b-494d-892d-67dc067289b7.png
- ■ Image uses http://: "Find A Store" (fc08601a-fcce-4c96-8b90-39e5a55d6c05.png): Non-HTTPS source may be blocked — src: http://image.emails.skechers.com/lib/fe3115707564047a731c78/m/11/fc08601a-fcce-4c96-8b90-39e5a55d6c05.png
- ■ Image uses http://: "Instagram" (b782e0aa-782c-4fb6-967b-d1dfa5ecbfdc.png): Non-HTTPS source may be blocked — src: http://image.emails.skechers.com/lib/fe3115707564047a731c78/m/11/b782e0aa-782c-4fb6-967b-d1dfa5ecbfdc.png
- ■ Image uses http://: "Facebook" (a5c4cae0-7aed-467a-a3ae-b290eea2a4a2.png): Non-HTTPS source may be blocked — src: http://image.emails.skechers.com/lib/fe3115707564047a731c78/m/11/a5c4cae0-7aed-467a-a3ae-b290eea2a4a2.png
- ■ Image uses http://: "YouTube" (8c5738fc-7644-4cbf-8fab-b04355a320a7.png): Non-HTTPS source may be blocked — src: http://image.emails.skechers.com/lib/fe3115707564047a731c78/m/11/8c5738fc-7644-4cbf-8fab-b04355a320a7.png
- ✘ Plain-text fallback missing or too short: Text version is 0 chars

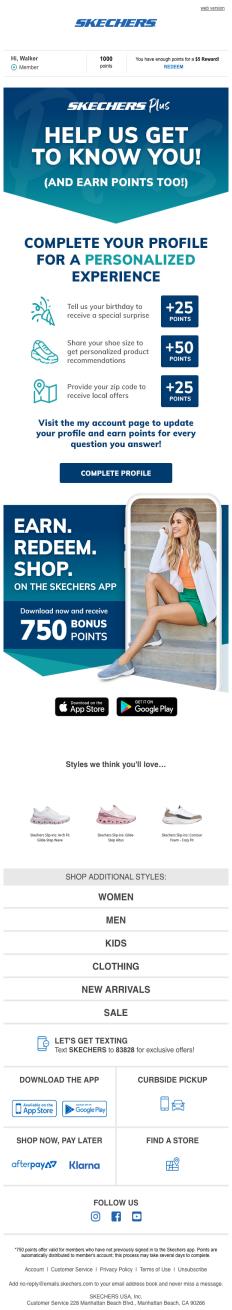
Personalization & Merge

- ✘ Empty greeting slot: Greeting has empty name field (e.g. "Hi ,")

Compliance & Deliverability

- ■ Authentication-Results header not found: Expected via AgentMail relay — SPF/DKIM status unknown

Visual Reference



Visual source: hosted web-view render when available.

Reference Artifacts

Web view: https://view.emails.skechers.com/?qs=eyJkZWtJZCI6IjUxYTA3ZDQxLTkwNzctNDAxNS04ZTdiLTQxYTM3NmY4NzNkZiIsImRla1Zlcn Npb24iOjEsIml2IjoiazI3ZDUyRFVEa0llWGk2UHRTeG5iZz09IiwiY2lwaGVyVGV4dCI6IkRrUUhSYWRudjVYNkJIb0tRekdEWCs0NUZCdlVIUWxw dExndUNkNENGTGdNeHpxSXVRWlJXRlg4VVhGVnBZSFBTSnc0dXoyWVhBYnZ4b2dqVjBtUjB0YjNGS24yU0hQOThiNlorTzlZeldBVDIwTmNS U0NYMFArRzlXR0w0Wk51M2VkZzFBNUNIbDR1ajdVc1oyND0iLCJhdXRoVGFnIjoieldBVDIwTmNSU0NYMFArRzlXR0w0UT09In0%3D

Saved HTML: /Users/alontsang/.openclaw-walker/workspace/reports/email-artifacts/2026-03-16-tell-us-more-about-you/message.html

Saved message JSON: /Users/alontsang/.openclaw-walker/workspace/reports/email-artifacts/2026-03-16-tell-us-more-about-you/message.json

Bottom Line

A welcome series email #3 should be a high-confidence, well-tested send — this is a triggered lifecycle message that fires repeatedly to new members. The broken greeting token and broken product rec links are not minor oversights; they're production failures on a send that should have been QA'd to a higher standard. The HTTP asset issue is systemic and likely

affects other emails in the program. Fix the token, fix the rec links, and fix the CDN before the next cohort triggers this send.